Mars Mission Overview

The Ares program sends an uncrewed lander to the Jezero crater.
The primary objective is to collect twelve rock cores and cache them for a later return to Earth.
The lander carries a small helicopter that scouts the terrain ahead.
The helicopter recharges from a solar panel.

Communications and Landing

The mission uses the Deep Space Network for commanding.
Each uplink window lasts about eight hours.
Round-trip light time to Mars is between five and twenty minutes.
Entry, descent and landing is called the seven minutes of terror.